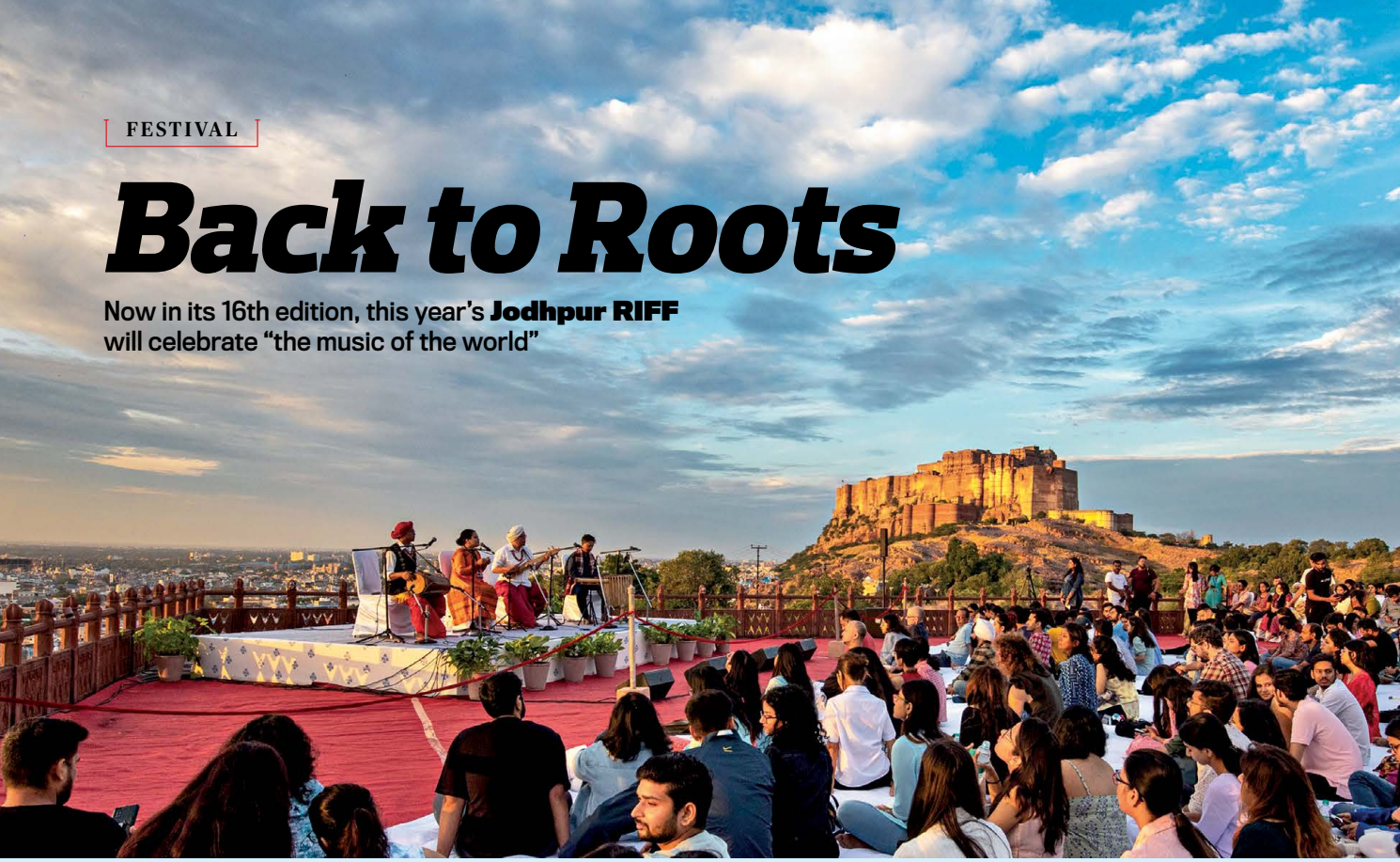
FESTIVAL

Back to Roots

Now in its 16th edition, this year's Jodhpur RIFF will celebrate "the music of the world"



Though it's located in the state that's home to the most popular form of folk music in the country, the organisers of the Jodhpur RIFF would like everyone to know that it's more than just a folk music festival. While RIFF was originally an acronym for the Rajasthan International Folk Festival, its team has not referred to this full form in years and instead calls the event a 'roots music' extravaganza.

"The term 'folk' is a bit of a misnomer," says festival director Divya Bhatia. "How folk is viewed in the US is different from how it's viewed in the UK. The broad understanding tends to be the American [definition]. So, Bob Dylan is a folk singer, but the kind of music he does and what Rajasthani artists do is so different".

The use of 'roots

FESTIVAL

Clowns in Town

The ninth edition of the **INTERNATIONAL CLOWN FESTIVAL** is the biggest one yet, with 30 shows across four Indian cities

While clowns are typically characterised by red noses, bold makeup, exaggerated facial expressions and loud costumes, there's so much more that sets them apart. "The art of clowning requires skill and practice. Unfortunately, people in India have not been exposed to high-quality entertainment and have only seen clowns in circuses or birthday parties. Clowns across the globe perform in theatre shows and at carnivals, and are supported by the government," says Martin D'Souza, an award-winning clown and the former vice-president of the World Clown Association. As creative entertainers, clowns are adept at comedy, juggling, acrobatics, circus acts, magic and music. It is this versatile skill set that D'Souza aims to showcase through the International Clown Festival (ICF) 2023, an initiative that was launched in 2010 and is currently in its ninth edition.

Organised by Mad Hatters, a division of D'Souza's company Lighthouse Entertainment, the



MARTIN D'SOUZA